“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 10

The Meeting with the Vaiṣṇavas

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 I worship that raincloud, Gaura, who by the nectar of His own sight brought back to life the crops of His devotees, withered by the drought of separation.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![2]

3 Earlier, when Mahāprabhu had gone to the south, King Pratāparudra summoned Sārvabhauma.

4 Bowing to him, the king offered him a seat and then asked him for news of Mahāprabhu.

5 “I have heard that a great soul has come from Gauḍa and is staying in your house, and that He is supremely merciful.

6 Everyone says that He has shown you great mercy. Be kind enough to let me see Him.”

7 The Bhaṭṭācārya said, “All that you have heard is true. But it is not possible for you to see Him.

8 He is a renounced sannyāsī who lives in solitude; not even in a dream would He meet a king.

9 Still, I would have found some way to arrange for you to see Him; but just now He has gone to the south."

10 The king asked, "Why did He leave Jagannātha and go away?" The Bhaṭṭācārya replied, "That is a pastime of great souls.[3]

11 To purify the holy places, He travels on pilgrimage, and on that pretext He delivers worldly people.

12 "Devotees such as you are themselves holy places, my lord. By the Lord who dwells within your hearts, you make even the holy places holy." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.13.10)[4]

13 That is the unchanging nature of a Vaiṣṇava. But He is no jīva: He is the independent Lord Himself."[5]

14 The king said, "Why did you let Him go? Why did you not fall at His feet and do all you could to keep Him here?"

15 The Bhaṭṭācārya said, "He is the Lord Himself, fully independent — Śrī Kṛṣṇa in person. He depends on no one.

16 Even so, I tried very hard to keep Him; but the Lord's will is His own, and I could not hold Him back."

17 The king said, "Bhaṭṭa, you are the crest-jewel of the learned. Since you call Him Kṛṣṇa, I accept it as the truth.

18 When He comes here again, let me see Him even once, so that my eyes may find their fulfilment."

19 The Bhaṭṭācārya said, "He will come back soon. I would like a secluded place for Him to stay.

20 It should be close to Jagannātha and yet quiet. Please decide on such a place and grant it."

21 The king said, "Kāśī Miśra's house is just such a place. It is near the Lord and very secluded."[6]

22 Having said this, the king waited eagerly, and the Bhaṭṭācārya went and told Kāśī Miśra.

23 Kāśī Miśra said, "I am most fortunate: Prabhupāda will stay in my house!"[7]

24 In this way all the people of Puruṣottama were eager to meet the Lord.

25 When everyone's longing had grown intense, Mahāprabhu hastened back from the south.[8]

26 Hearing of it, everyone rejoiced. They all came to Sārvabhauma and pleaded with him:

27 "Arrange for us all to see the Lord. By your grace may we reach His feet."

28 The Bhaṭṭācārya said, "Tomorrow the Lord will go to Kāśī Miśra's house; there I will bring you all to meet Him."

29 The next day Mahāprabhu went with the Bhaṭṭācārya and joyfully saw Jagannātha.

30 There the servants of the Deity met Him and gave Him mahā-prasāda, and Mahāprabhu embraced them all.

31 Having seen Jagannātha, the Lord came out, and the Bhaṭṭācārya brought Him to Kāśī Miśra's house.[9]

32 Kāśī Miśra came and fell at the Lord's feet, and offered Him his house and his very self.

33 The Lord showed him His four-armed form, made him His own and embraced him.

34 Then Mahāprabhu sat down there, and the devotees headed by Nityānanda sat all around Him.

35 The Lord was pleased to see how the residence was arranged: it held everything He would need.

36 Sārvabhauma said, "Lord, this residence is worthy of You. Kāśī Miśra hopes that You will accept it."

37 The Lord said, "This body belongs to all of you. Whatever you say, that I must do."

38 Then Sārvabhauma, seated at the Lord's right, began to introduce to Him all the residents of Puruṣottama:

39 "Lord, all these people live in Nīlācala. They have all been longing to meet You.

40 Just as thirsty *cātaka* birds cry out in distress, so do these people. Please accept them all.

41 This is Janārdana, a servant of Jagannātha. During the *anavasara* he serves the Lord's divine body.[10]

42 This is Kṛṣṇadāsa, who bears the golden staff, and this is Śikhi Māhiti, the scribe.[11]

43 This is Pradyumna Miśra, foremost among the Vaiṣṇavas. He is Jagannātha's chief cook and is known by the name Dāsa.[12]

44 This is Murāri Māhiti, Śikhi Māhiti's brother. He has no refuge but Your feet.

45 These are Candaneśvara, Siṁheśvara, Murāri the brāhmaṇa and Viṣṇudāsa; they all meditate on Your feet.

46 This is the Praharārāja Mahāpātra, a man of great wisdom; his name is Paramānanda Mahāpātra.[13]

47 All these Vaiṣṇavas are the ornaments of this holy place. With one-pointed devotion they all think of Your feet."

48 Then they all fell flat on the ground like rods, and the Lord graciously embraced each of them.

49 Just then Bhavānanda Rāya arrived and, with his four sons, fell at Mahāprabhu's feet.[14]

50 Sārvabhauma said, "This is Bhavānanda Rāya. His eldest son is Rāmānanda Rāya."

51 Then Mahāprabhu embraced him and spoke at length in praise of Rāmānanda:

52 “The glory of one whose son is a jewel like Rāmānanda cannot be described in this world.

53 You are Pāṇḍu himself, and your wife is Kuntī; your five wise sons are the five Pāṇḍavas.”

54 Rāya said, “I am a fallen, worldly śūdra, yet You touch me — this is the mark of the Lord.

55 Together with my house, my wealth, my servants and my five sons, I have surrendered myself at Your feet.

56 Vāṇīnātha here will stay at Your feet and carry out whatever You order, whenever You order it.

57 Regard me as Your own and do not hold back with me: whatever You wish, whenever You wish it, simply give the order.”[15]

58 The Lord said, “Why should I hold back? You are no stranger. Birth after birth you and your family have been My servants.

59 Rāmānanda will come within five or seven days. In his company My joy will be complete.”

60 Saying this, the Lord embraced him, and his sons all placed the Lord’s feet on their heads.[16]

61 Then Mahāprabhu sent him home, keeping Vāṇīnātha Paṭṭanāyaka with Him.

62 The Bhaṭṭācārya saw all the people off, and the Lord then called for Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa.

63 The Lord said, “Bhaṭṭācārya, hear what this man did. He went with Me to the south.

64 There he left Me and went off to the Bhaṭṭathāris; I rescued him from them and brought him back.

65 Now that I have brought him here, I have dismissed him. Let him go wherever he likes; I am no longer responsible for him.”

66 Hearing this, Kṛṣṇadāsa began to weep, and Mahāprabhu went off to attend to His midday duties.

67 Then Nityānanda, Jagadānanda, Mukunda and Dāmodara took counsel together in private:[17]

68 “We need to send someone to Gauḍa to tell mother Śacī that the Lord has returned.

69 When they hear of the Lord’s return, all the devotees headed by Advaita and Śrīvāsa will come.

70 We will send this Kṛṣṇadāsa to Gauḍa.” Saying this, they reassured him and kept him with them.

71 The next day they put their request to the Lord: “Give us permission to send someone to Gauḍa.

72 Ever since they heard that You went south, mother Śacī and all the devotees headed by Advaita have been grieving.

73 Let someone go and tell them the good news." The Lord said, "Do as you wish."

74 So they sent Kṛṣṇadāsa to Gauḍa with mahā-prasāda for all the Vaiṣṇavas.

75 Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa came to Gauḍa and went to mother Śacī in Navadvīpa.

76 He gave her the mahā-prasāda, bowed to her and told her the news: the Lord had come back from the south.

77 Hearing it, mother Śacī rejoiced at heart, and so did Śrīvāsa and all the other devotees.

78 Everyone who heard it was overjoyed. Then Kṛṣṇadāsa went to the house of Advaita Ācārya.

79 He gave the Ācārya the prasāda, bowed to Him and told Him all the news of Mahāprabhu.

80 Hearing it, Ācārya Gosāñi was filled with joy. Absorbed in love, He danced and sang and roared again and again.

81–84 Haridāsa Ṭhākura was overjoyed, and so were Vāsudeva Datta, Murāri Gupta, Śivānanda Sena, Ācāryaratna, Vakreśvara Paṇḍita, Ācāryanidhi, Gadādhara Paṇḍita, Śrīrāma Paṇḍita, Dāmodara Paṇḍita, Śrīmān Paṇḍita, Vijaya, Śrīdhara, Rāghava Paṇḍita, Ācārya Nandana — how can I name all the other devotees?

85 Filled with delight, they all went together to Śrī Advaita.

86 All of them bowed at the Ācārya's feet, and Ācārya Gosāñi embraced them all.

87 For two or three days the Ācārya held a great festival, and then He firmly resolved to go to Nīlācala.

88 They all gathered together in Navadvīpa and, taking mother Śacī's permission, set out for Nīlādri.

89 Hearing the news of the Lord, the residents of Kulīna-grāma — Satyarāja, Rāmānanda and all the rest — came and joined them.

90 Mukunda, Narahari and Raghunandana came from Khaṇḍa to the Ācārya, to go with Him to Nīlācala.

91 At that time Paramānanda Purī, coming from the south along the bank of the Gaṅgā, arrived in the town of Nadīyā.

92 He stayed happily in mother Śacī's house, and she respectfully gave him his meal.

93 There he heard of the Lord's return, and he wanted to go to Nīlācala at once.[18]

94 Taking with him one of the Lord's devotees, a brāhmaṇa named Kamalākānta, he set out for Nīlācala.

95 He came quickly and met the Lord, and the Lord rejoiced to have him there.

96 Overwhelmed with love, the Lord bowed down at his feet; and Paramānanda Purī, overwhelmed with love, embraced Him.

97 The Lord said, "I long to live in your company. Be merciful to Me and make Nīlādri your home."

98 Purī replied, “I too long to live in Your company. That is why I set out from Gauḍa and came to the city of Nīlācala.

99 When they heard that You had come back from the south, Śacī was overjoyed, and so were all the devotees.

100 They are all coming to see You, but since they were delayed, I hurried on ahead.”

101 The Lord gave him a secluded room in Kāśī Miśra’s house, and a servant to attend him.

102 The next day Svarūpa Dāmodara arrived — the Lord’s most intimate companion, an ocean of rasa.

103 In his former *āśrama* his name was Puruṣottama Ācārya, and he lived in Navadvīpa at the Lord’s feet.

104 When he saw the Lord accept sannyāsa, he became as if mad; he went to Vārāṇasī and took sannyāsa himself.

105 His guru, Caitanyānanda, ordered him, “Study Vedānta and teach it to everyone.”[19]

106 He was supremely renounced and supremely learned, and with body and mind he had taken shelter of Śrī Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes.[20]

107 “I shall worship Kṛṣṇa free of every care” — for this very reason he accepted sannyāsa in his madness.

108 He took sannyāsa by giving up his *śikhā* and sacred thread, but he did not receive the *yogapaṭṭa*, and his name became “Svarūpa.”[21]

109 With his guru's leave he came to Nīlācala, and there, night and day, he was overwhelmed with the bliss of love for Kṛṣṇa.

110 His learning knew no bounds, yet he spoke with no one; he lived in solitude, and people knew nothing of him.

111 He knew the truth of Kṛṣṇa-rasa, and his very body was love itself; he was, in truth, Mahāprabhu's second self.[22]

112 If anyone brought the Lord a book, a verse or a song, the Lord would hear it only after Svarūpa had examined it.

113 Anything contrary to the conclusions of bhakti, or any *rasābhāsa* (a mere semblance of rasa), brought the Lord's heart no delight when He heard it.

114 Therefore Svarūpa Gosāñi examined everything, and only if it was pure did he let the Lord hear it.

115 With the songs of Vidyāpati and Caṇḍīdāsa and the *Śrī Gīta-govinda* — these three — he delighted the Lord.[23]

116 In music he was like a Gandharva, in scripture a Bṛhaspati; there was no one else so great-minded as Dāmodara.[24]

117 He was most dear to Advaita and Nityānanda, and to Śrīvāsa and the other devotees he was as dear as life itself.

118 Dāmodara came and fell prostrate before the Lord; then, clasping His feet, he began to recite this verse:[25]

119 “O Śrī Caitanya, ocean of mercy! Your mercy blows away all sorrow as easily as dust. It is pure; in it the highest bliss blossoms, and before it all quarrels over scripture fall silent. It bestows rasa and fills the heart with divine madness; it ever draws one to devotion, it intoxicates with rapture, and in it lies the very limit of sweetness. May that all-auspicious mercy rise upon me!” (Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka, 8.14)[26]

120 Mahāprabhu raised him up and embraced him, and both of them, overwhelmed with love, lost consciousness.

121 After a while, when they had both grown calm, Mahāprabhu began to speak to him:

122 “Today I saw in a dream that you would come. How good this is! It is as if a blind man had received his sight.”

123 Svarūpa said, “My Lord, forgive my offence. I left You and went elsewhere, and that was a grave mistake.

124 I have not a trace of love for Your feet; sinner that I am, I left You and went off to another land.

125 I left You, but You did not leave me: You bound me by the neck with the rope of Your mercy and brought me back to Your feet.”

126 Then Svarūpa bowed at the feet of Nitāi, and Nityānanda Prabhu embraced him with love.

127 He met Jagadānanda, Mukunda, Śaṅkara and Sārvabhauma, greeting each as was fitting.

128 He bowed at the feet of Paramānanda Purī, and Purī Gosāñi embraced him with love.

129 Mahāprabhu gave him a secluded dwelling and a servant to bring him water and see to his other needs.

130 The next day Mahāprabhu was sitting with Sārvabhauma and other devotees, joyfully speaking of Kṛṣṇa.

131 At that moment Govinda arrived; bowing down, he humbly said:

132 "I am the servant of Īśvara Purī, and my name is Govinda. On Purī Gosāñi's order I have come to You.

133 At the time of his passing, Gosāñi ordered me, 'Go to Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and serve Him.'

134 Kāśīśvara will come after visiting all the holy places, but on my master's order I have hurried to Your feet."

135 The Lord said, "Purīśvara has always had a father's affection for Me; out of mercy he has sent you to Me."

136 Hearing this, Sārvabhauma asked the Lord, "Why did Purī Gosāñi keep a servant of śūdra birth?"

137 The Lord said, "Īśvara is supremely independent, and Īśvara's mercy is not subject to the injunctions of the Vedas.[27]

138 The mercy of Īśvara takes no account of caste or family: Kṛṣṇa ate in the house of Vidura.[28]

139 Śrī Kṛṣṇa's mercy depends on nothing but loving service; won over by love, He acts with complete freedom.[29]

140 For Him whose very name brings supreme bliss to those who hear it, loving dealings give millions of times more joy than reverential formality."

141 Saying this, the Lord embraced Govinda, and Govinda bowed at His feet.

142 The Lord said, "Bhaṭṭācārya, consider this: My guru's servant is worthy of My respect.

143 It is not proper for Me to have him serve Me, yet My guru has ordered it. What am I to do?"

144 The Bhaṭṭa said, "The guru's order is mighty, and one must not transgress it. Scripture bears witness to this:

145 "Lakṣmaṇa had heard how Paraśurāma, on his father's order, struck down even his own mother as though she were an enemy; and so he accepted his elder brother's command, for the orders of one's elders are not to be questioned." (Raghuvaṁśa, 14.46)[30]

146 "I must carry out the order of my guru, that great soul, without deliberation; in this lies your good, and mine above all." (Rāmāyaṇa, Ayodhyākāṇḍa, 22.9)[31]

147 Then Mahāprabhu accepted him and gave him the right to serve His own sacred person.

148 Everyone honoured Govinda as the Lord's dear servant, and Govinda looked after all the Vaiṣṇavas.

149 The two Haridāsas, the junior and the senior, both kīrtana singers, and Rāmāi and Nandāi stayed with Govinda.

150 Together with Govinda they served the Lord. No one can describe how boundless Govinda's good fortune was.

151 The next day Mukunda Datta came to the Lord and said, "Brahmānanda Bhāratī has come to see You.

152 If You permit, shall I bring him here?" The Lord said, "He is a guru to Me; I shall go to him Myself."[32]

153 Saying this, Mahāprabhu set out with the devotees and came before Brahmānanda Bhāratī.

154 Brahmānanda was wearing a deerskin, and when the Lord saw it He was pained at heart.

155 Though He saw him, He pretended not to, and asked Mukunda, "Where is Bhāratī Gosāñi?"

156 Mukunda said, "Here he is, right before You." The Lord said, "That is not he. You are mistaken.

157 You are taking someone else for him; you simply do not know. Why would Bhāratī Gosāñi wear a hide?"

158 Hearing this, Brahmānanda reflected in his heart: "He does not like this skin garment of mine.

159 He is right: I wear this skin only out of pride. Wearing a skin will not carry me across saṁsāra.[33]

160 From today I shall not wear this skin." Knowing his heart, the Lord had a sannyāsī's outer cloth brought for him.

161 When Brahmānanda had cast off the skin and put on cloth, the Lord came and bowed at his feet.

162 Bhāratī said, “Your conduct is meant to teach people. I am afraid in my heart that You will not bow to me again.[34]

163 Now there are two Brahmans here, the moving and the unmoving: Jagannātha is the unmoving Brahman, and You are the moving Brahman.[35]

164 You are golden in colour and He is dark; these two Brahmans have delivered the whole world.”

165 The Lord said, “I tell you the truth: with your arrival two Brahmans have become manifest in Śrī Puruṣottama.

166 You, whose name is Brahmānanda, are the golden Brahman, the moving one, while dark Jagannātha sits there unmoving.”

167 Bhāratī said, “Sārvabhauma, be the arbiter and consider carefully this argument between Him and me.

168 I understand the jīva and Brahman as the pervaded (*vyāpya*) and the pervader (*vyāpaka*): the jīva is the pervaded and Brahman the pervader, as scripture explains.

169 He has purified me by removing my skin, and the reason is just this: He is the pervader, and I am the pervaded.[36]

170 “He is of golden colour, His limbs are like gold, His form is beautiful, and He wears armlets of sandal. He has taken sannyāsa, He is self-restrained and tranquil, and His highest refuge is steadfastness and peace.” (Mahābhārata, Dāna-dharma, 149; Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma, 92 and 75)[37]

171 He is the very abode of all these names: the sandal-anointed prasāda cords on His two arms are His armlets."[38]

172 The Bhaṭṭācārya said, "Bhāratī, I see that the victory is yours." The Lord said, "Whatever you say is true.

173 In a dispute between guru and disciple, the disciple's defeat is certain." Bhāratī said, "That is not so; there is another reason.

174 It is Your nature to be defeated by Your devotees. And hear one thing more, about Your own power.

175 All my life I meditated on the formless, but now that I have seen You, Kṛṣṇa has become manifest before me.

176 The name of Kṛṣṇa springs to my lips, and Kṛṣṇa fills my mind and eyes. I see that very form in You, and my heart is filled with longing.

177 The very change that Bilvamaṅgala underwent has come over me on seeing Him:

178 "I was worshipped by those who walk the path of non-dualism, and I had received initiation on the throne of the bliss of the self; yet a certain rogue, a lover of the cowherd maidens, has forcibly made me a maidservant." (Śrī Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta)[39]

179 The Lord said, "You have deep love for Kṛṣṇa; wherever your eyes fall, Kṛṣṇa manifests to you."

180 The Bhaṭṭācārya said, "What You say is true — if Kṛṣṇa has indeed appeared before him face to face.[40]

181 Without prema there is never a direct vision of Him; it is by the mercy of this One that Bhāratī has had His darśana."[41]

182 The Lord said, "Viṣṇu! Viṣṇu! What are you saying, Sārvabhauma? Such excessive praise is a mark of censure."

183 Saying this, the Lord brought Bhāratī to His own residence, and from then on Bhāratī Gosāñi stayed with Him.

184 Rāmabhadrācārya and Bhagavān Ācārya also stayed at the Lord's feet, setting aside all other affairs.[42]

185 The next day Kāśīśvara Gosāñi came, and the Lord received him with honour and kept him with Himself.[43]

186 He would take the Lord for the darśana of Jagannātha, walking ahead and keeping back the crowds.

187 As all rivers and streams flow into the ocean, so Mahāprabhu's devotees, wherever they were,

188 all came and met at the Lord's holy feet, and the Lord mercifully kept them all with Him.

189 Thus I have described the Lord's meeting with the Vaiṣṇavas. Whoever hears this attains the feet of Caitanya.

190 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. Heading in the edition: “Obeisance to Gaura, the treasure of the devotees’ life.” ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 4.2; translation as there. ↩
3. *Anubhāṣya*: on verses 10–11 it refers to Madhya 8.39 and *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 4.30.37 — devotees travel to purify the holy places. ↩
4. The same verse as Ādi 1.63; translation as there. Here the edition reads «তীর্থীভূতাঃ» (in Ādi 1.63, «তীর্থভূতাঃ»). ↩
5. *Anubhāṣya*: pure devotees purify the holy places by their coming and deliver the worldly people who live there — such is their eternal nature, for they suffer at the suffering of others; but Śrī Mahāprabhu, though He plays the part of a devotee, is the independent Supreme Lord Himself. ↩
6. *Anubhāṣya*: Kāśī Miśra’s house is the present Śrī Rādhākānta Maṭha in the Bālisāhi quarter, a little south of the temple; in those days the place was secluded. ↩
7. *Anubhāṣya*: Mahāprabhu, Nityānanda and Advaita are called “Prabhupāda” because They are *viṣṇu-tattva*, the eternal Lord of the jīva; the Gurudeva is called “Oṁ Viṣṇupāda”, and a pure Vaiṣṇava “Śrīpāda”. ↩
8. Heading in the edition: “The longing to serve is the thread that binds the devotee and Bhagavān.” ↩
9. The edition reads «দরশন করি’ প্রভু» (the earlier text had «মহাপ্রভু»); the Bengali and the transliteration follow the edition (scan, p. 501). ↩
10. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *anavasara* is the period after the Snāna-yātrā until the darśana of “Nava-yauvana”. ↩
11. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *likhana-adhikārī* is the official holding the post of *deula-karaṇa*, who keeps the temple chronicle (the “Mādalā-pāñji”). *Anubhāṣya*: on Śikhi Māhiti see Antya 2.104–106. ↩
12. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *mahā-soyāra* means *mahā-sūpakāra*, the chief cook, the superintendent of the kitchen. *Anubhāṣya*: adding “dāsa” to a brāhmaṇa’s name, as a sign that he is a servant of Viṣṇu, is sanctioned also by Culli Bhaṭṭa. ↩
13. *Anubhāṣya*: *praharārāja* is a hereditary title of a family of royal priests in Utkala: when the king dies, one of them sits on the throne holding the royal sceptre for one *prahara*, until the heir is anointed, so that the throne is never left empty. In the edition this is one person: “(10) Paramānanda”. ↩
14. *Anubhāṣya*: the four sons are Rāmānanda Rāya’s brothers — Vāṇīnātha, Gopīnātha, Kalānidhi and Sudhānidhi (see Ādi 10.133). ↩
15. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “know me as Your own” — that is, be kind to me as to one of Your own; there is no need to hesitate in anything. ↩

16. *Anubhāṣya*: *śire* — each on his own head. ↩
17. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *antara* — secretly, or stepping aside. ↩
18. *Anubhāṣya*: Paramānanda Purī learnt of the Lord's return while still in Śrī Māyāpura, from Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa, whom he had known before. ↩
19. *Anubhāṣya*: Caitanyānanda is Caitanyānanda Bhāratī (so the commentary on the *Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka*). ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya* quotes Kavi Karṇapūra's *Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka*: he accepted the fourth āśrama by the force of renunciation alone, yet out of love for the pollen of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet he held that very āśrama of little account. ↩
21. The edition reads *yoga-paṭṭa nā dila* ("the *yogapaṭṭa* was not given"); another reading is *nā nila* ("he did not take"). *Anubhāṣya*: he performed the rites of sannyāsa — the eight śrāddhas, the virajā-homa, shaving the śikhā, giving up the thread — but did not wait for the *yogapaṭṭa*, the sannyāsa name and the daṇḍa; so he kept the name "Dāmodara Svarūpa," the name of a lifelong celibate (*naiṣṭhika-brahmacārī*). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: he took sannyāsa not to add to any pride of āśrama, but only to serve Kṛṣṇa free of care. ↩
22. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: whoever saw him felt as if a second form of Mahāprabhu had arisen. Heading in the edition: "The Lord's second form." ↩
23. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Vidyāpati was an old Vaiṣṇava poet of Mithilā; Caṇḍīdāsa, an old Bengali Vaiṣṇava poet of the village of Nānnura (Bīrbhūm district); the *Śrī Gīta-govinda* is Śrī Jayadeva's celebrated poem of Sanskrit songs on Kṛṣṇa-rasa. ↩
24. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Mahāprabhu had earlier given him the name "Dāmodara," seeing his skill in song; joined to the name "Svarūpa," given by his sannyāsa-guru, it made him "Dāmodara-Svarūpa." He also wrote a book on the science of music, the *Saṅgīta-Dāmodara*. ↩
25. The edition reads *caraṇe dhariyā* ("clasping His feet"); another reading is *paḍiyā* ("falling at His feet"). ↩
26. *Anubhāṣya*: the Lord's mercy first ends the *anarthas* and purifies the heart, so that the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa is revealed; then it gives the conclusions of bhakti, and through them rasa and the madness of love; and at last attachment to bhakti and the summit of sweetness. *Sa-madayā* — full of rapture (*mada*); with the reading *śama-dayā*, "bestowing peace." Heading in the edition: "In the *Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka* Dāmodara-Svarūpa enters while the Lord is speaking with Sārvabhauma, and offers this prayer." ↩

27. *Anubhāṣya*: according to smṛti, a brāhmaṇa who accepts a man of another varṇa as his disciple or servant becomes fallen — hence Sārvabhauma's question. Mahāprabhu answers: "My gurudeva is 'Īśvara,' a lord of the world; the smṛti that governs ordinary jīvas has no hold on him, and the mercy of such a powerful one is never bound by Vedic injunctions." The Lord plays on the name of Īśvara Purī. ↩
28. *Anubhāṣya*: as Kṛṣṇa, the guru of the world, set aside worldly considerations of caste and family and ate in Vidura's house, so Īśvara Purī mercifully disregarded Govinda's birth in a śūdra family: knowing that a Vaiṣṇava is worthy of brāhmaṇa status through initiation, he initiated him and accepted him as his servant. ↩
29. The edition reads *sneha-sevāpekṣā* ("depends on loving service"); another reading is *sneha-leśāpekṣā* ("waits for a mere trace of love"). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: service is of two kinds, service in love (*sneha-sevā*) and service in reverence (*maryādā-sevā*); Kṛṣṇa's mercy comes where there is service in love. ↩
30. *Anubhāṣya*: the command of Śrī Rāmacandra was to take Sītā to the forest. The source is given as in the edition (*Raghuvaṁśa*, canto 14, verse 46). ↩
31. *Anubhāṣya*: the guru here is Rāma's father, Daśaratha. ↩
32. *Anubhāṣya* (heading): the Lord keeps to propriety (*maryādā*); at 173 Brahmānanda Bhāratī is called "equal to a guru." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Brahmānanda Bhāratī was worthy of the Lord's respect through his relation to Keśava Bhāratī. ↩
33. *Anubhāṣya* (on 154): a garment of skin, grass or bark is worn only by one who has left home for the forest (*Manu-saṁhitā*, ch. 6); but to wear a skin out of pride, to win people's regard, does not free one from saṁsāra: "Though the fruit of the kataka tree clears water, the water does not become clear merely by uttering its name" (*Manu* 6.67) — so the mere bearing of outer signs is not the cause of dharma. ↩
34. *Anubhāṣya*: "Your conduct is only to teach people. If I do not keep the right conduct You expect of me, You Yourself will not bow to me again and will disregard me. That is what I fear." ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: the Deity of Śrī Jagannātha is the unmoving Brahman, and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu the moving Brahman; both, the masters of māyā, are now present in Śrī Puruṣottama. At 166 the Lord plays on the name "Brahmānanda." ↩
36. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Brahman is all-pervading (*vyāpaka*), while the jīva is atomic (*aṇu*) and pervaded by Brahman. He who took off my skin and

purified me is the pervader, and I am the pervaded; so judge who is “Brahman” here — I, Brahmānanda Bhāratī, or He, Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. ↩

37. The same verse as Ādi 3.49 (= Madhya 6.104); translation as there. Here the edition gives the source as Dāna-dharma, chapter 127 (at Ādi 3.49, 149); the reference is kept as at Ādi 3.49. ↩
38. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the armlets on the Lord’s arms are the prasāda cord itself, smeared with sandal; so the name *candanāṅgadī* (“wearing sandal armlets”) of verse 170 finds its place in Him. ↩
39. The source is given as in the edition. *Anubhāṣya*: “we” is a plural of respect, to be understood as “I”; the travellers on the path of advaita are the *kevalādvaitins*, who teach the formless Brahman; those “initiated on the throne of their own bliss” are such as follow the path of yoga; the rogue, the lover of the cowherd maidens, is the son of Nanda. Bilvamaṅgala Ṭhākura had been an advaitin in a former life, then became a devotee of Kṛṣṇa and told of it himself (on 175–177). ↩
40. *Anubhāṣya* (on 179–181): what Mahāprabhu says — that the mahā-bhāgavata Brahmānanda has seen Kṛṣṇa — is true, for Kṛṣṇa appears face to face before a mahā-bhāgavata; but without abundant prema such vision is impossible, and Brahmānanda saw Kṛṣṇa by Mahāprabhu’s mercy. ↩
41. *Anubhāṣya*: the first *iṅhāra* means “by the mercy of Śrī Mahāprabhu,” the second “Brahmānanda Bhāratī’s”: he had darśana, that is, he saw Kṛṣṇa. ↩
42. *Anubhāṣya*: on Rāmabhadrācārya see Ādi 10.148; on Bhagavān Ācārya, Ādi 10.135–136. ↩
43. *Anubhāṣya*: on Kāśīśvara see the *Anubhāṣya* to Ādi 8.66; Murāri’s diary says: “Then all the devotees who lived in Gauḍa wished to go to Nīlācala to see Gaurāṅga: Śrī Kāśīśvara Gosvāmī…” ↩